AUSTRALIAN PROPERTY MARKET DATA · RESEARCHER BRIEFING

What Is the Domain Dataset, and What Can You Do With It?

An overview of the Domain property dataset: what it contains, how it is structured, and what research it can support.

Domain API via AURIN (Australian Urban Research Infrastructure Network)

Where does this data come from, and what is in it?

Domain.com.au is one of Australia's largest property listings websites. Agents post listings there and sale results are recorded, creating a continuously updated view of the market in **every Australian state and territory**, which researchers reach through **AURIN**.

📍 Agents & Listings API *the live advertised market*

Individual listings, one record per property advertised on Domain, plus who is advertising them.

- **Residential listings:** for sale, for rent, shared, sold, new homes
- **Commercial and business listings:** for sale or lease
- **Agencies and agents** behind each listing
- **New development projects** and the units inside them
- Search by suburb and postcode, or by a polygon drawn on a map. Refreshed daily.

Best for: fine-grained, spatial or transaction-level analysis, down to a single street.

📊 Property Data API *area-level market intelligence*

Suburb-level summaries and property-level lookups, for comparing places and tracking change over time.

- **Suburb performance statistics:** prices, sales, days on market, rents, ~10 years
- **Census demographics** per suburb: 2011, 2016, 2021
- **Weekly auction results** for major cities (current week only)
- **Property records** and address lookup
- **Suburb profiles** from Domain's location model. Statistics refreshed monthly.

Best for: trends, comparisons across suburbs and cities, and policy analysis.

Not a one-time snapshot. Both are **live query services**, not files to download: each question is answered in real time from Domain's current data. **Rule of thumb:** a question about an area → Property Data; about specific properties or transactions → Agents & Listings.

Suburb-Level Summaries: What's in Them?

Snapshots per suburb at quarterly, half-yearly, and annual intervals, over a rolling window of roughly the last decade. Houses and units are queried separately.

What each period record contains

- **Median sold price:** the middle sale price for the period
- **Number of sales:** how many properties actually sold
- **Days on market:** how long homes typically sat before selling
- **Auction clearance rate:** share of auctions that resulted in a sale
- **Median asking rent:** typical advertised rental price
- **Rental yield:** annual rent as a percentage of property value
- **Price distribution:** 5th, 25th, 75th, 95th percentile prices
- **Discount rate:** how much sellers typically dropped their asking price

✅ Best for questions like...

- "How have median house prices in Fitzroy changed over the last decade?"
- "Which inner-Melbourne suburbs had the fastest-selling properties last year?"
- "How did COVID affect rental demand in coastal areas?"

💡 Good to know

- **Houses and units are separate queries.** "House" includes townhouses, duplexes, terraces and semis; "unit" includes apartments, flats, studios and villas. Vacant land is in neither.
- **Up to 45 periods**, back to February 2015, refreshed monthly on the 25th.
- **Quiet suburbs have gaps:** Domain withholds figures for low-volume quarters.
- **Rental yield** averages per-property yields, using each property's estimated value while it was listed for rent.

Individual Property Records: What's in Them?

Each record is one listing at one point in time, across three markets. All three carry the address, coordinates, price, advertising agency, features and photos.

🏠 Residential

Homes for sale, for rent, shared, sold, and new homes

- **Type:** house, apartment, townhouse, land, rural and more
- **Size:** bedrooms, bathrooms, car spaces, land and building area
- **Sales:** sold price and date; asking price or range
- **Sale outcome:** auction, sold prior to auction, private treaty, withdrawn
- **Rentals:** asking rent, bond, availability date, leased rent and date
- **Features:** up to 41 advertiser tags (pool, air conditioning, solar panels, water views...)

Dense from 2018; back to ~2000 but sparse

🏢 Commercial

Offices, retail, industrial and other commercial property

- **Market:** for sale, for lease, sold and leased
- **Size:** land and building area, car spaces, units offered
- **Price:** sale or lease price, total or per m^2, GST treatment
- **Sale type:** standard sale, auction, expression of interest, tender
- **Investment:** occupancy (tenanted or vacant), annual return %, lease terms
- **Energy:** NABERS rating (0–6 stars) where reported

Mainly current and recent activity

💼 Business

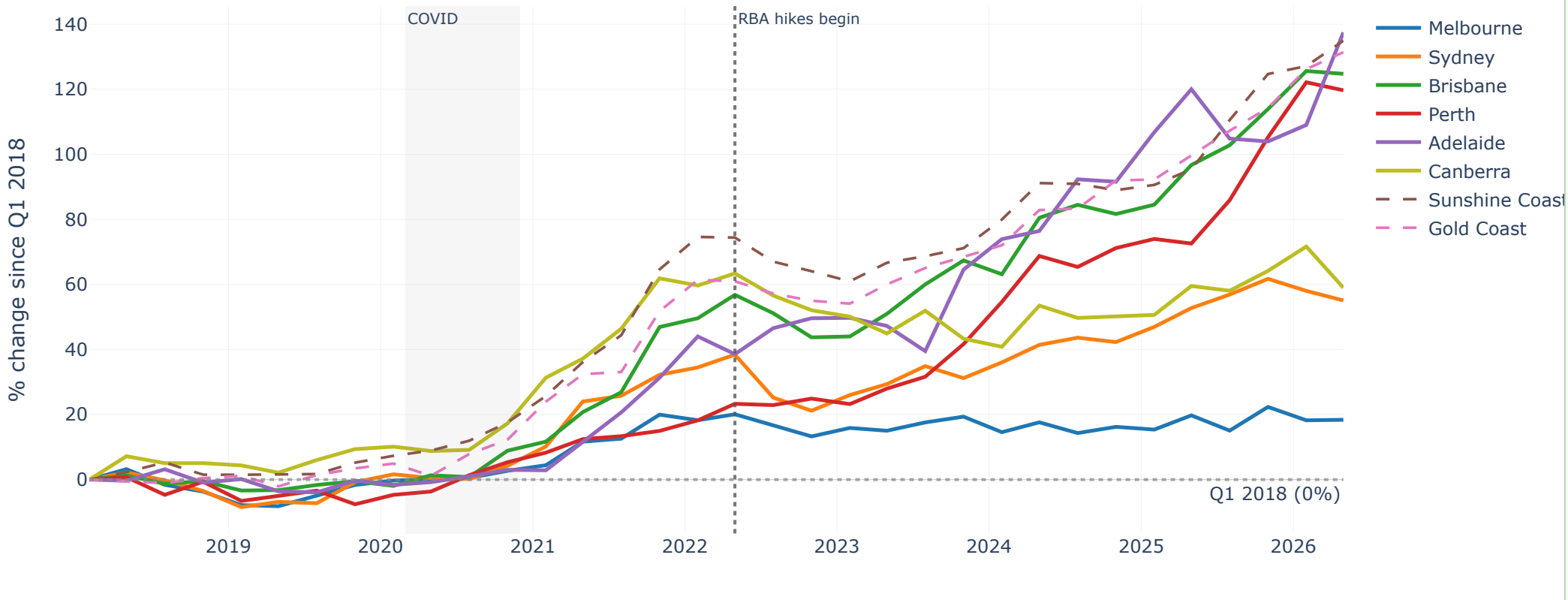
Businesses and franchise opportunities for sale

- **Category:** retail, hospitality, services, franchise and more
- **Price:** asking price or range
- **Premises:** leasehold details, or a link to the freehold commercial listing
- **Franchise:** searchable by brand and franchise group
- **Energy:** NABERS rating where reported

Mainly current and recent activity

Example: Price Trends Across Australian Markets

All markets indexed to Q1 2018, so they can be compared regardless of their absolute price levels. Capitals are solid, coastal lifestyle markets dashed.

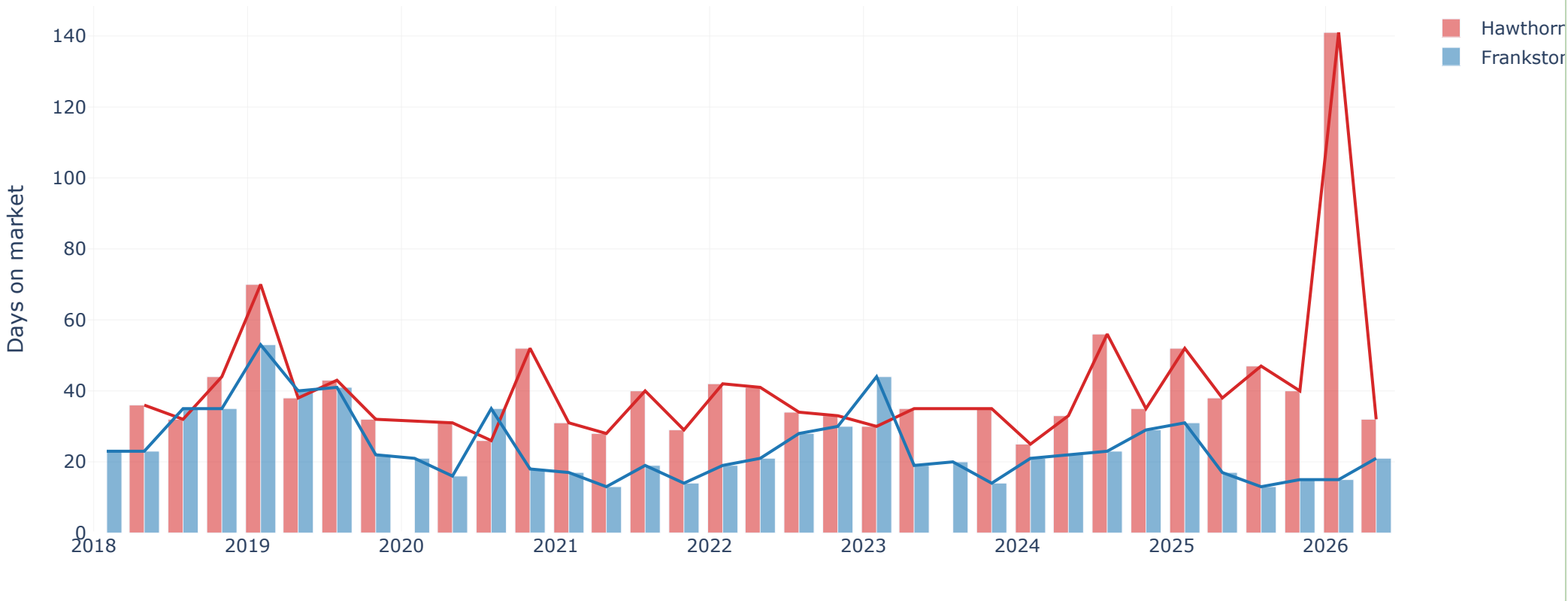


House price change since Q1 2018, eight Australian markets. Capitals shown solid, coastal lifestyle markets dashed. Click any city in the legend to hide or show it. Source: Domain API suburb performance statistics.

Built from suburb-level summary data: a sample of 30 suburbs per city spanning its price range, taken as the median of those suburb medians each quarter. Houses in Brisbane, Perth, Adelaide and both Queensland coasts roughly doubled since 2018; Sydney rose 55% and Melbourne just 18%.

Example: How Long Properties Take to Sell

"Days on market" measures how long a typical property sits before a buyer is found. A low number signals a hot market; a high number signals a buyer's market.

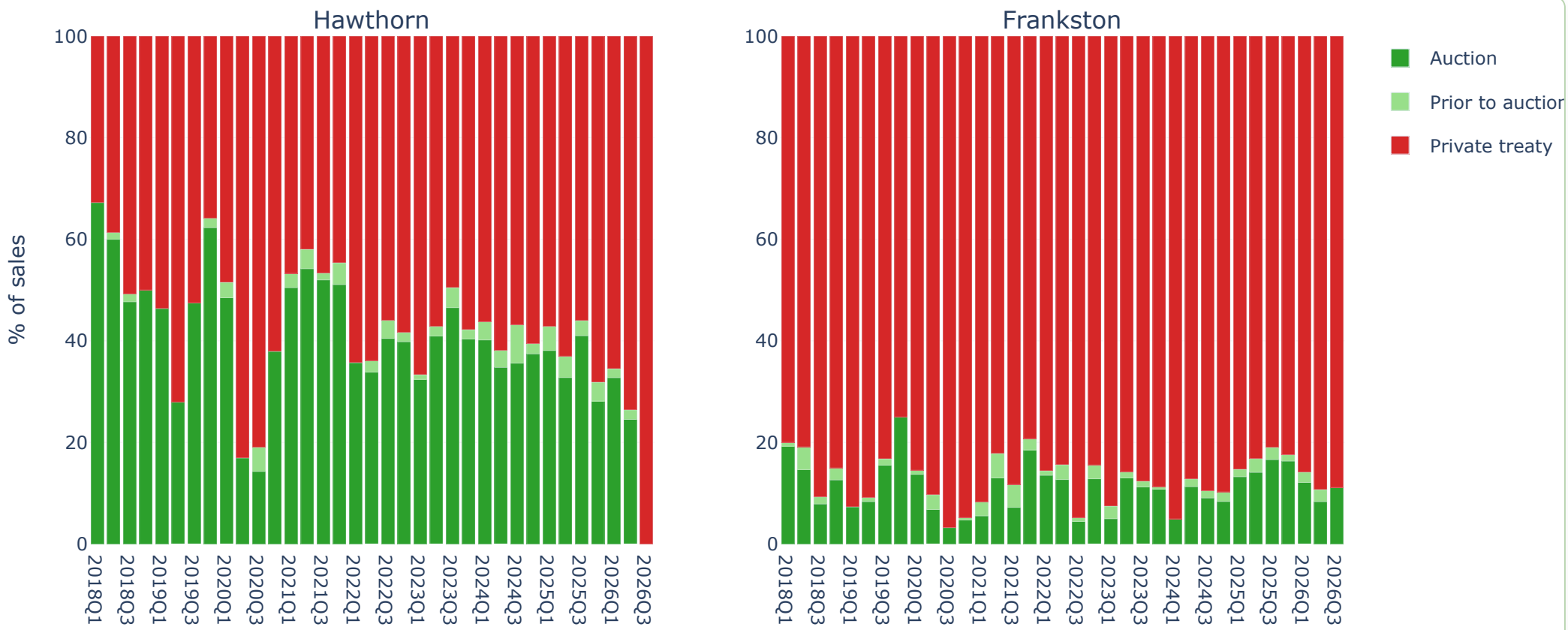


Median days on market, houses only, with the quarterly series drawn as both bars and a line. Hawthorn (inner Melbourne, premium) against Frankston (outer south-east, affordable). Source: Domain API `/v2/suburbPerformanceStatistics`.

The same suburb-level data that gives you median prices also gives you this demand signal. The reliable reading here is the gap in level between the two suburbs, not the trend within either: a Frankston house sells in about three weeks, a Hawthorn house in about five.

Example: How Properties Are Sold

The mix of auctions vs private sales shifts with market conditions and differs sharply between suburbs.



Sale method mix by quarter, as a share of all sales. Split three ways: cleared at auction, sold prior to auction, and private treaty. Click the legend to toggle a method across both suburbs. Source: Domain API residential listings endpoint.

Hawthorn leans on auctions; Frankston defaults to private treaty, where conditional contracts suit first-home buyers. Only Hawthorn's mix moves, drifting down roughly ten points after 2022, while Frankston's holds steady.

How does access work?

Access is managed by AURIN and is available to approved researchers at Australian universities and research organisations.

🔐 Getting access, step by step

1. Approval	Through a breakthrough opportunity, or a relevant activity under your Node AAP.
2. Agreement	Sign the AURIN data transfer agreement (DTA). **Your access period starts on the day you sign.**
3. Credentials	Collect your AURIN Data Provider username and password. There is no separate API key to generate.
4. First query	Follow the Getting Started guide in the training materials (Python or R) and run one test call.

> **Every call costs one credit.** 5,000 credits per researcher per month: see the next slide for how to plan them.

🗓️ How long you have access



6 months from signing the DTA, or **April 2027**, whichever comes first.

⏳ April 2027 is a hard cutoff

That is when the agreement between AURIN and Domain ends. Anyone signing from November 2026 onwards gets **less than six months**, and the closer to April you sign, the shorter your window.

🎯 Plan your collection early

Scope the queries your study needs before you sign, then collect and cache the data within your window. Access does not carry over once it ends.

Planning your credits

Every call to the API costs one credit, whatever comes back. The allowance is generous for a focused project, but it is easy to spend on mistakes.

5,000
credits per researcher, per month

1
credit per call, even if it returns nothing

1st
of each month, the balance resets

+
need more? Ask AURIN, approved case by case

What it costs	Credits
~10 years of quarterly statistics for one suburb (houses *or* units)	**1**
The same suburb, houses *and* units	**2**
A call with a typo, a wrong state, or an empty result	**1**
One year of sold listings across Greater Melbourne	**~900**
Greater Perth, ~9 years (2018 to 2026): statistics, ~300,000 sales, and ~160,000 rentals from the 3 busiest agencies per postcode	**~6,100**

Four habits that save credits

- **Probe first:** ask for one record to see how big a query is before running it in full.
- **Ask for the full history:** 45 periods of suburb statistics cost the same as 4, so filter locally.
- **One polygon, not many suburbs:** a single map area over your study region replaces one query per suburb.
- **Save every response:** re-running cached data is free; re-querying is not.

Running out mid-collection fails silently. The API simply stops returning data, and nothing in your output shows which suburbs were never reached. Check your balance in the AURIN dashboard (Manage Access → API Access) before any large run.

What this data can and cannot do

A quick reference to check before designing a study around this source.

What you can get

Yes	**Suburb-level price trends, last ~10 years**	Quarterly, half-yearly and annual
Yes	**Individual sold property records from 2018**	Densely covered from that point
Yes	**Current rental listings**	A live snapshot of what is advertised on the query day
Yes	**Days on market, auction rates, sale method**	Per suburb and period
Yes	**Suburb demographics**	Census years only: 2011, 2016, 2021
Partial	**Listing records before 2018**	Available back to ~2000, but very sparse
Partial	**SA2 / SA3 / SA4 figures**	Needs a mapping step with the correspondence files
Partial	**Historical rental listings**	Only through the archives of agencies still trading, about 15-20% of an area's 2018 rentals, rising to about 40% today
Partial	**Energy efficiency ratings**	ACT listings only, on each listing's own record, 1 credit per listing

What you cannot get

No	**A complete rental history**	Search is live only, and closed agencies cannot be found
No	**Suburb statistics before February 2015**	Outside the rolling window
No	**Bulk download of all records for a state**	Query by query, and at most 1,000 records per query: larger result sets are cut off without warning
No	**Original asking price after a property sells**	Overwritten on sale
No	**A complete record of all sales**	Only properties advertised on Domain.com.au: a market view, not an administrative record
No	**Vacancy rates**	Active listings measure availability, not vacancy
No	**Achieved rents for every rental**	Leased rent is recorded on about half of historical rental records; live listings show asking rent only

Data quality: what to watch for

None of these are bugs, but each will distort an analysis if nobody accounts for it. Check them before you trust a median.

🙈 More prices withheld lately

Recent sales are more often missing a disclosed price, and a disappointing result is the more likely to be held back, so recent-quarter medians rest on an incomplete and probably biased subset.

What to do: treat the latest quarters as provisional, and report how many sales had no price.

📍 Missing prices are uneven

About 2% of sold listings carry no price overall, but in one suburb it reached almost 30%.

What to do: check the missing-price share per area before comparing areas.

🏢 Filter out commercial records

Left in, commercial listings moved one dataset's median weekly rent from **$525 to $950**.

What to do: filter by property type explicitly before computing residential medians.

🧭 Locations are not always right

Domain's suburb and postcode fields are occasionally wrong, and ~2% of records have no coordinates.

What to do: validate locations spatially, and aggregate by postcode rather than exact position.

Outliers are real. A live snapshot held a one-bedroom at $32 a week and a townhouse at $7,800 a week. Flag them in your quality checks rather than deleting them silently.

What you can publish is a separate question

Everything above is about what you can *retrieve*. Domain treats internal analysis and published output as two different stages, and the second one carries restrictions.

📚 Stage one: internal research

Use the data freely to develop hypotheses, analyse, identify trends and inform your work. Nothing on the right constrains this.

⚠️ Stage two: anything public

Publishing, distributing or commercialising findings outside your internal environment **needs Domain's review and approval**. There is no definitive list of what will pass, so raise the use case early rather than at submission.

📝 Which agreement are you under?

The **API agreement** covers applied research, academic publication and internal non-commercial proofs of concept. The **sample data agreement**, for the static sample datasets, is **internal evaluation only** and excludes research and publication outright.

In a published output	Typically
Listing descriptions Third-party copyright	**Not allowed**
Property images Copyright and licensing	**One hero image**
Agent names and phone numbers Privacy	**Not allowed**
A property's full listing history Licensing and commercial sensitivity	**Latest sale only**
Anything supporting direct marketing Privacy and terms of use	**Not allowed**
Individual records: addresses, exact coordinates, a property's price Unit-level data, even when drawn as a map	**Restricted**
Aggregates, medians, distributions, area-level findings No individual property identifiable	**Unrestricted**

The rule to design around. The restricted elements are **research inputs only**. They may inform the analysis, but they should not appear in published outputs. Report the property market outcomes rather than the images, descriptions, agent details or unit-level history that produced them.

Questions?

Training materials, worked examples, and a credit cost calculator are available in the accompanying guides and Jupyter notebooks. Start with the Getting Started guide.

Domain API · Accessed via AURIN · Data from Domain.com.au